

Security Cleanup Checklist

A simple step-by-step plan from the September 10, 2026 security meeting

IMPORTANT: Follow these steps in order. Do not erase the old Mac or phone until the new passwords work and your important files are safe.

1 Start with a clean computer

- ☐ Use a new computer or one that was not involved in the incident.
- ☐ Do not change passwords from the current Mac or phone.
- ☐ Install all available software updates on the clean computer.

2 Purchase Malwarebytes for Mac

- ☐ On the clean computer, open Safari.
- ☐ Type this exact address into the address bar:

<https://www.malwarebytes.com/mac>

- ☐ Purchase Malwarebytes Premium Security for Mac.
- ☐ Install it on the new or factory-reset Mac.
- ☐ Run a full scan.
- ☐ Turn on real-time protection and automatic updates.
- ☐ Ignore Malwarebytes offers from pop-ups, emails, or advertisements.

3 Secure the most important accounts

Change these passwords from the clean computer, in this order:

- ☐ Main email or Google account
- ☐ Apple account
- ☐ Bluehost account
- ☐ Bank, credit-card, and other financial accounts
- ☐ Facebook, Instagram, and other social-media accounts
- ☐ Any other account that used the same or a similar password

For every account:

- ☐ Create a completely new password.
- ☐ Never reuse a password from another account.
- ☐ Save the password in Apple Passwords or Keychain when prompted.
- ☐ Turn on two-step verification.
- ☐ Confirm the recovery email address and phone number belong to you.
- ☐ Sign out other devices or sessions when that option is available.

4 Protect yourself from more scams

- ☐ Do not click security links in emails or text messages.
- ☐ Open the company's official app or type its website address yourself.
- ☐ Never give a verification code to someone over the phone.
- ☐ Ignore anyone claiming to be "Google Tech Support" who contacts you unexpectedly.
- ☐ Call banks and other companies using the number on their official website or the back of your card.

5 Check financial accounts

- ☐ Make sure you can sign in to every financial account from the clean computer.
- ☐ Review recent activity for charges or changes you do not recognize.
- ☐ Contact the bank or card company immediately if anything looks wrong.
- ☐ Keep security and credit-monitoring alerts turned on.

6 Clean up the Mac

Do this only after the new passwords work and important files are safe.

- ☐ Copy only essential documents, photos, and business files.
- ☐ Do not copy unfamiliar programs, installers, or browser extensions.
- ☐ Completely erase and factory-reset the Mac.
- ☐ Reinstall only the programs you actually need.
- ☐ Do not reinstall MacKeeper or other unnecessary cleanup tools.

7 Replace or reset the phone

- ☐ Confirm important photos, contacts, and other essentials are backed up.
- ☐ Make sure financial accounts work on the clean computer first.
- ☐ Replace or trade in the phone if possible.
- ☐ Avoid restoring a complete old backup that could bring unwanted settings back.
- ☐ Install apps individually from the official App Store.

8 Final check

- ☐ Confirm the new passwords work on the clean devices.
- ☐ Confirm two-step verification works.
- ☐ Confirm the recovery email and phone number are correct.
- ☐ Confirm there are no unknown devices signed into the accounts.
- ☐ Ask for help before continuing if something looks unfamiliar or suspicious.

WHEN IN DOUBT, STOP. Do not click the link, approve the login, or give anyone a security code. Call me before continuing.